Volume I was punctuated by short conversations between Lenny and George, fictional personas who were loosely based on two John Steinbeck characters. The setting for this volume of the Theoretical Minimum series is inspired by the stories of Damon Runyon. It's a world filled with crooks, con artists, degenerates, smooth operators, and do-gooders. Plus a few ordinary folks, just trying to get through the day. The action unfolds at a popular watering hole called Hilbert's Place.

Into this setting stroll Lenny and Art, two greenhorns from California who somehow got separated from their tour bus. Wish them luck. They will need it.

WHAT TO BRING

You don't need to be a physicist to take this journey, but you should have some basic knowledge of calculus and linear algebra. You should also know something about the material covered in *Volume I*. It's OK if your math is a bit rusty. We'll review and explain much of it as we go, especially the material on linear algebra. *Volume* I reviews the basic ideas of calculus.

Don't let our lighthearted humor fool you into thinking that we're writing for airheads. We're not. Our goal is to make a difficult subject "as simple as possible, but no simpler," and we hope to have a little fun along the way. See you at Hilbert's Place.